

Vatsal Mehra

BUILDER • EDUCATOR • THINKING COACH • COMMUNITY DESIGNER

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SUMMARY

Builder, educator, and thinking coach with over a decade in software and bioinformatics. I spent years building tools for biomedical research, then shifted toward the craft of good thinking — designing and facilitating rationality workshops, coaching people through better decisions and resilience, and building communities for epistemic and personal growth. Drawn to work that pairs technical problem-solving with a real understanding of human behavior.

EXPERIENCE

Facilitator, Futurekind Fellowship

Apr 2026 — Jul 2026

Electric Sheep

Facilitating two Futurekind Fellowship cohorts and, on the Builder Track, helping build AI tools for animal welfare.

Workshop Designer & Facilitator

Aug 2025 — Present

EA Infrastructure Fund & Effective Ventures

Running 12 hands-on workshops across Bangalore & Hyderabad that help people think more clearly, make better decisions, and catch their own biases.

Founder & Coach

Nov 2024 — Present

Rational Resilience

Built and lead a coaching practice that helps clients make better decisions and build resilience by blending practical problem-solving with emotional awareness.

Co-founder

Sep 2024 — Present

Portal (MetaRationality LLP)

Building a community space for epistemic & emotional growth that inspires impactful work on local & global catastrophic risks.

Product Manager

Nov 2022 — Feb 2024

Indx.AI / OneCell Diagnostics

Built and managed the iCare platform, enabling oncologists to read patients' mutational profiles and suggest appropriate cancer therapies.

- Translated stakeholder requirements into interfaces and bioinformatics pipelines.
- Led a team of developers and bioinformaticians across iCare projects.
- Designed flagship products OncoDx and OncoPredikt, and owned deployment across the SDLC.

Data Scientist

Aug 2021 — Nov 2022

Indx.AI

Built a web app from scratch that identifies and annotates rare cancer mutations, giving oncologists an interactive interface to track patients and find treatments.

Bioinformatician

Dec 2018 — Jan 2021

Marquette University

Solo developer for a lab studying spinal-cord-injury recovery; built pipelines and web tools revealing genetic and epigenetic regulation of axon growth.

- Pipelines that discovered novel transcription-factor combinations regulating axon growth.
- Web tools to visualize ATAC-Seq, RNA-Seq & ChIP-Seq across developmental time points, and to map supraspinal neurons by spinal projection.

Programmer Analyst

Apr 2018 — Jul 2018

Medical College of Wisconsin

Built a tool for the Rat Genome Database to visualize and perform set operations on gene lists.

SKILLS

Full Stack

JavaScript / Vue.js, Python / Flask, Node.js / Express, MySQL · Redis · MongoDB, Docker / Kubernetes, REST / GraphQL, R, Git, Nginx

Visualization

d3.js · Observable · Vega, Plotly / ggplot, Three.js

Bioinformatics / ML

NGS pipelines (DNA-, RNA-, ATAC-Seq), Biopython, Bioconductor, scikit-learn

EDUCATION

MS, Bioinformatics

Marquette University

2014 — 2016

B.Tech, Computer Engineering

NMIMS

2006 — 2010

TALKS & WORKSHOPS

Planning Fallacy: Why We Underestimate Time

EAGX Delhi — Talk & Workshop
Dec 2025

Calibration & Cognitive Biases Workshop

EAGX Bangalore — building calibration with confidence intervals
Oct 2024

SELECTED PROJECTS

Rationality Workshops

Hands-on workshops on thinking & decision-making

Teach Me A Bias

Learn cognitive biases and how to overcome them

Mouse Brain Development DB

Interactive visualizations of time-series NGS data

Cerebral Podcast

Conversations on human biases and better thinking

Bioinformatics Support Analyst Blood Center of Wisconsin Built Flask web tools automating the Molecular Diagnostics Lab workflow; monitored clinical-genomics NGS, built variant calling/annotation pipelines, and shipped d3.js tools (incl. VIRAS) for analyzing patient reports.	Oct 2016 – Mar 2018
Research Assistant Marquette University Built SNPredict, a machine-learning tool (kNN, LinearSVC) that predicts rare somatic variants, and automated RNA-Seq / ChIP-Seq workflows.	Aug 2015 – Oct 2016
Software Engineer Tech Mahindra Led production support; designed and maintained Bash automation for monitoring and updating AT&T servers.	Aug 2010 – Nov 2013

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Brain-wide analysis of the supraspinal connectome reveals anatomical correlates to functional recovery after spinal injury 2022 · <i>eLife</i>	Co-occupancy identifies transcription factor co-operation for axon growth 2021 · <i>Nature Communications</i>
Developmental chromatin restriction of pro-growth gene networks acts as an epigenetic barrier to axon regeneration in cortical neurons 2018 · <i>Developmental Neurobiology</i>	KLF6 and STAT3 co-occupy regulatory DNA and functionally synergize to promote axon growth in CNS neurons 2018 · <i>Scientific Reports</i>
Direct HLA Genetic Comparisons Identify Highly Matched Unrelated Donor–Recipient Pairs with Improved Transplantation Outcome 2018 · <i>Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation</i>	